Statecraft Israel Game Design

Core systems and player choices

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MVP scope 1948 to 1951

The MVP tells the story of the Liberation War, the austerity period (תקופת הצנע), and immigration during 1948-1951.

Each turn advances history by one month. The MVP targets approximately 48 turns, giving the player time to finish the war, house and employ immigrants, construct the Tel-Aviv to Haifa railway, and establish new yishuvim.

Objectives

1. **Survive the Liberation War.** Earn bonus points for finishing the war earlier than its historical end and for capturing enemy soldiers.
2. **Absorb immigrants.** Provide immigrants with housing and employment.
3. **Establish key infrastructure.** Complete the Tel-Aviv to Haifa railway and establish new yishuvim at designated sites.

Historical events on objective completion

Each time an objective is completed, it triggers a historical event card connected to the corresponding real event. The card contains an authentic image of that event, a short historical account, and the actual date when it happened.

The card also shows when the player completed the objective. Compare the player's completion date with the actual historical date: completing it earlier awards bonus points. Exact point values remain open.

Core gameplay

A turn-based strategy game about building and defending Israel. Players allocate people and limited resources to employment, settlement, infrastructure and military activity, then respond to events that change their situation.

The rules below define the current design direction. Items marked Open or Proposal need a decision before implementation. Resource amounts, action costs and balance values remain unset.

Player decisions and turn loop

The central decision is where people should contribute next. A civilian can take a job, enter military training or train as a pioneer. These choices compete for the same available population.

Proposed turn structure: review resources and city needs; move units, issue orders, start city projects and choose ministers; select event outcomes; resolve production, consumption, training, construction and combat. The order of resolution and the number of actions per turn are open.

Minister selection TBD

The player can choose ministers. TBD: minister roles, available candidates, appointment rules, costs and effects on gameplay.

Resources and national parameters

Resource or parameter	Role	Still to define
Money	Funds development and other paid actions. Craftsmen earn more money.	Income per job, construction costs and upkeep.
Arms	Available military equipment.	Supply sources; whether training, attacks or replacements consume it.
Food	Available food supply.	Production, imports, consumption and storage; stockpile or supply capacity.
Social cohesion לכידות חברתית	National parameter describing cohesion in society. Proposed influences include housing, employment and shortages.	Scale, thresholds and gameplay effects; effects of military decisions and events.
International Support	National parameter describing support from other countries. Proposed influences include military decisions and events.	Scale, thresholds and gameplay effects.

Population and units

Unit	Defined role	Open rule
Refugee	Included as a population unit.	Arrival, resettlement and transition to civilian.
Civilian	Can take an employment slot or enter military or pioneer training.	Job reassignment, housing use and return from trained roles.
Craftsman	Generates more money than an ordinary civilian.	How acquired; employment requirements and extra income.
Halutz or pioneer	Builds map infrastructure and performs land improvement work.	Work duration, resource cost, project commitment and simultaneous project limit.
Veteran pioneer	Experienced pioneer unit.	Promotion requirement and benefit over a pioneer.
Recruit	Military unit after basic training.	Combat strength, upkeep and training duration.
Veteran soldier	Experienced military unit.	Promotion requirement and benefit over a recruit.
Artillery	Artillery unit with the working label Napoleonchik.	Acquisition, crew, range, ammunition and combat role.
Armored car Israeli	Israeli armored combat unit.	Acquisition, armor, movement and combat rules.
Arab Legionnaire	Unit representing an Arab Legion soldier.	Equipment, movement, strength and behavior.
Palestinian militia	Palestinian militia unit.	Equipment, movement, strength and behavior.

Movement and civilian actions

The player can move units. Movement allowance, terrain costs, road and rail effects, stacking, transport and access to enemy territory are open.

A civilian can be employed in an available city employment slot. A civilian can train in a military camp and become a recruit, or train in a Hakhshara (הכשרה) and become a Halutz. The source of a Hakhshara and whether the player builds one are open.

Progression

Civilian to recruit through basic training, and civilian to Halutz through pioneer training, are defined transitions. Refugee to civilian, civilian to craftsman, Halutz to veteran pioneer, and recruit to veteran soldier are open transitions. Veteran roles are part of the roster, but their progression is not yet specified.

Open: does a unit represent one person or a group? The answer must determine how units occupy housing and jobs, produce income, consume food, train and suffer casualties.

Cities and construction

City attribute	Meaning	Open rule
Housing capacity	How much population the city can house.	People per capacity point; treatment of overflow.
Housing condition	The quality or condition of available housing.	City average or per building; effects and improvement rules.
Employment slots	The number of available jobs.	Worker types, income and effects of unemployment.

City projects

Housing and industry, including specialized industry, are city projects. The player selects and starts these projects in a city.

City project	Defined effect	Requirement
Industry	Provides employment slots.	A permitted building site; costs and build time open.
Housing	Provides capacity, improves conditions, or both.	A permitted building site; housing types open.
Specialized industry	Adds a location-dependent industry.	City has the relevant local resource or area. A winery requires areas for grapes.

A city has both capacity and conditions: adding more room and improving the quality of existing housing are separate development choices. The method for assigning residents to housing is open.

Pioneer work

Building is allowed only at designated spots. A new yishuv uses the name associated with its designated site. The player chooses whether and when to develop an available site.

Pioneer action	Target or result
Build road	Construct a road along a designated corridor. Costs and construction duration remain open.
Build railroad	Construct a railway along a designated corridor. Costs, duration and operating requirements remain open.
Plow fields	Prepare agricultural land. Food yield and required ongoing labor remain open.
Dry swamp	Improve a wetland area. Completion effects and later land uses remain open.
Build yishuv	Found a settlement at a designated spot, using that spot's name.
Build military training camp	Create a military training location at a designated site. Training capacity remains open.

Military actions and settlement control

Soldier action	Defined intent	Open rule
Fortify position	Prepare the current position for defence.	Cost, duration, persistence and defensive benefit.
Hold position	Remain on sentry duty at the position.	Protection area, interception and upkeep.
Attack	Engage an enemy target.	Valid targets, range, combat resolution and losses.

Recruits and veteran soldiers use the infantry action set. Artillery has a separate combat role whose orders and rules are open. Enemy combatants and settlement residents require distinct states in the settlement-control system.

After capturing an enemy city or village

The player selects one of three outcomes:

- Raid and withdraw: clear hostile forces, then leave. Duration and effects on future hostile presence remain open.
- Occupy: retain control of the location and begin an occupation period. Required forces, costs and local effects remain open.
- Deport: remove settlement residents. Which residents are affected, their destination and the resulting settlement state remain open. Deportation and razing need separate rules: moving residents does not specify whether buildings are destroyed.

After X turns of occupation, the player chooses to install a puppet regime or annex the settlement. X is unset. A puppet regime provides indirect control; annexation incorporates the settlement into the player's territory. Population management, jobs, housing, defense responsibilities and resource access under each outcome are open.

Open: when is a settlement captured, what constitutes enemy control, and can an occupying force withdraw before the timer ends? Capturing enemy soldiers earns the bonus specified in the MVP objectives. Settlement-control rewards and political penalties remain open.

Events and consequences

The player responds to events by selecting an outcome that produces a bonus, a penalty, or both. Effects can target money, arms, food, Social cohesion and International Support. Effects on units, cities or project availability are a proposal. Completed MVP objectives also trigger the historical event cards described at the beginning of this document.

Each event needs a trigger, readable context, available options and their consequences. Open: event frequency, mandatory versus optional events, delayed effects, and how much the player can see before choosing.

Historical dates, unit identities, named places and claims in event text require sources. Game balance values and hypothetical alternatives must be identified as design assumptions.

Production decisions to resolve

Designated building sites and transport corridors bound the locations and routes we must support. Population scale, project timing and the effect of terrain on movement remain major decisions for map production.

Decision	Why it changes production
Road and rail corridors	Routes follow designated corridors. Each corridor needs predefined route geometry and construction states. The corridor list, costs and duration remain open.
Unit population scale	A person or a group changes unit count, housing and job assignment, selection, movement and casualty representation.
Population role model	Changing one unit between jobs and training differs from separate worker pools. Decide reassignment and return to civilian life.
Work and training time	Instant actions and multi-turn projects require different feedback, commitment rules, cancellation and progress displays.
Food and arms supply	National pools need fewer logistics rules. Local storage and supply routes add transport, shortages and vulnerability to disruption.
Settlement control	Occupation, indirect rule, annexation, displacement and destruction require explicit population, ownership and building states.

MVP completion rules

The MVP years, monthly turns and three objectives are fixed above. Remaining decisions include the exact starting month, map extent, starting unit counts, event count and session length. Define when the war-survival objective is complete, which immigrants must have housing and employment, and which new yishuvim are required.

Each objective needs a specific historical event and reference date for the completion card. For ongoing processes such as immigrant absorption, choose a defined milestone with a sourced date. Bonus amounts, the timing formula, defeat conditions and whether all objectives are required to finish the MVP remain open.

Minister selection is a planned TBD mechanic with player-chosen ministers. The role of coalition, Attention, diplomacy and national policy systems in this core loop remains open.

Relationship to the existing design

The existing units-in-play design describes units as a presentation layer with no individual orders. This GDD calls for units, jobs, training, construction and settlement control to affect gameplay. Those rules must become simulation state and actions under the existing deterministic simulation architecture.

Reference files from the repository snapshot reviewed on 12 October 2026:

Original Statecraft Israel design specification

Units in play design and owner rulings

Roads and railways implementation notes

M3 scope rulings